



2022 AIME I Problems/Problem 12

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Problem

For any finite set X , let $|X|$ denote the number of elements in X . Define

$$S_n = \sum |A \cap B|,$$

where the sum is taken over all ordered pairs (A, B) such that A and B are subsets of $\{1, 2, 3, \dots, n\}$ with $|A| = |B|$. For example, $S_2 = 4$ because the sum is taken over the pairs of subsets

$$(A, B) \in \{(\emptyset, \emptyset), (\{1\}, \{1\}), (\{1\}, \{2\}), (\{2\}, \{1\}), (\{2\}, \{2\}), (\{1, 2\}, \{1, 2\})\},$$

giving $S_2 = 0 + 1 + 0 + 0 + 1 + 2 = 4$. Let $\frac{S_{2022}}{S_{2021}} = \frac{p}{q}$, where p and q are relatively prime positive integers. Find the remainder when $p + q$ is divided by 1000.

Solution 1 (Easy to Understand)

Let's try out for small values of n to get a feel for the problem. When $n = 1$, S_n is obviously 1. The problem states that for $n = 2$, S_n is 4. Let's try it out for $n = 3$.

Let's perform casework on the number of elements in A, B .

Case 1: $|A| = |B| = 1$

In this case, the only possible equivalencies will be if they are the exact same element, which happens 3 times.

Case 2: $|A| = |B| = 2$

In this case, if they share both elements, which happens 3 times, we will get 2 for each time, and if they share only one element, which also happens 6 times, we will get 1 for each time, for a total of 12 for this case.

Case 3: $|A| = |B| = 3$

In this case, the only possible scenario is that they both are the set $\{1, 2, 3\}$, and we have 3 for this case.

In total, $S_3 = 18$.

Now notice, the number of intersections by each element $1 \dots 3$, or in general, $1 \dots n$ is equal for each element because of symmetry - each element when

$n = 3$ adds 6 to the answer. Notice that $6 = \binom{4}{2}$ - let's prove that $S_n = n \cdot \binom{2n-2}{n-1}$ (note that you can assume this and answer the problem if

you're running short on time in the real test).

Let's analyze the element k - to find a general solution, we must count the number of these subsets that k appears in. For k to be in both A and B , we need both sets to contain k and another subset of 1 through n not including k . ($A = \{k\} \cup A' | A' \subset \{1, 2, \dots, n\} \wedge A' \not\subset \{k\}$ and $B = \{k\} \cup B' | B' \subset \{1, 2, \dots, n\} \wedge B' \not\subset \{k\}$)

For any $0 \leq l \leq n - 1$ that is the size of both A' and B' , the number of ways to choose the subsets A' and B' is $\binom{n-1}{l}$ for both subsets, so the

total number of ways to choose the subsets are $\binom{n-1}{l}^2$. Now we sum this over all possible l 's to find the total number of ways to form sets A and B that

contain k . This is equal to $\sum_{l=0}^{n-1} \binom{n-1}{l}^2$. This is a simplification of Vandermonde's identity, which states that

$$\sum_{k=0}^r \binom{m}{k} \cdot \binom{n}{r-k} = \binom{m+n}{r}. \text{ Here, } m, n \text{ and } r \text{ are all } n-1, \text{ so this sum is equal to } \binom{2n-2}{n-1}.$$

Finally, since we are iterating over all k 's for n values of k , we have $S_n = n \cdot \binom{2n-2}{n-1}$, proving our claim.

We now plug in S_n to the expression we want to find. This turns out to be $\frac{2022 \cdot \binom{4042}{2021}}{2021 \cdot \binom{4040}{2020}}$. Expanding produces $\frac{2022 \cdot 4042! \cdot 2020! \cdot 2020!}{2021 \cdot 4040! \cdot 2021! \cdot 2021!}$.

After cancellation, we have

$$\frac{2022 \cdot 4042 \cdot 4041}{2021 \cdot 2021 \cdot 2021} \implies \frac{4044 \cdot 4041}{2021 \cdot 2021}$$

4044 and 4041 don't have any common factors with 2021, so we're done with the simplification. We want to find

$$4044 \cdot 4041 + 2021^2 \pmod{1000} \equiv 44 \cdot 41 + 21^2 \pmod{1000} \equiv 1804 + 441 \pmod{1000} \equiv 2245 \pmod{1000} \equiv \boxed{245}$$

~KingRavi ~Edited by MY-2

Solution 2 (Linearity of Expectation)

We take cases based on the number of values in each of the subsets in the pair. Suppose we have k elements in each of the subsets in a pair (for a total of n

elements in the set). The expected number of elements in any random pair will be $n \cdot \frac{k}{n} \cdot \frac{k}{n}$ by linearity of expectation because for each of the n elements, there

is a $\frac{k}{n}$ probability that the element will be chosen. To find the sum over all such values, we multiply this quantity by $\binom{n}{k}^2$. Summing, we get

$$\sum_{k=1}^n \frac{k^2}{n} \binom{n}{k}^2$$

Notice that we can rewrite this as

$$\sum_{k=1}^n \frac{1}{n} \left(\frac{k \cdot n!}{(k)!(n-k)!} \right)^2 = \sum_{k=1}^n \frac{1}{n} n^2 \left(\frac{(n-1)!}{(k-1)!(n-k)!} \right)^2 = n \sum_{k=1}^n \binom{n-1}{k-1}^2 = n \sum_{k=1}^n \binom{n-1}{k-1} \binom{n-1}{n-k}$$

We can simplify this using Vandermonde's identity to get $n \binom{2n-2}{n-1}$. Evaluating this for 2022 and 2021 gives

$$\frac{2022 \binom{4042}{2021}}{2021 \binom{4040}{2020}} = \frac{2022 \cdot 4042 \cdot 4041}{2021^3} = \frac{2022 \cdot 2 \cdot 4041}{2021^2}$$

Evaluating the numerators and denominators mod 1000 gives $804 + 441 = 1 \boxed{245}$

- pi_is_3.14

Solution 3 (Rigorous)

For each element i , denote $x_i = (x_{i,A}, x_{i,B}) \in \{0, 1\}^2$, where $x_{i,A} = \mathbb{I}\{i \in A\}$ (resp. $x_{i,B} = \mathbb{I}\{i \in B\}$).

$$\text{Denote } \Omega = \left\{ (x_1, \dots, x_n) : \sum_{i=1}^n x_{i,A} = \sum_{i=1}^n x_{i,B} \right\}.$$

$$\text{Denote } \Omega_{-j} = \left\{ (x_1, \dots, x_{j-1}, x_{j+1}, \dots, x_n) : \sum_{i \neq j} x_{i,A} = \sum_{i \neq j} x_{i,B} \right\}.$$

Hence,

$$\begin{aligned}
S_n &= \sum_{(x_1, \dots, x_n) \in \Omega} \sum_{i=1}^n \mathbb{I}\{x_{i,A} = x_{i,B} = 1\} \\
&= \sum_{i=1}^n \sum_{(x_1, \dots, x_n) \in \Omega} \mathbb{I}\{x_{i,A} = x_{i,B} = 1\} \\
&= \sum_{i=1}^n \sum_{(x_1, \dots, x_{i-1}, x_{i+1}, \dots, x_n) \in \Omega_{-i}} 1 \\
&= \sum_{i=1}^n \sum_{j=0}^{n-1} \binom{n-1}{j}^2 \\
&= n \sum_{j=0}^{n-1} \binom{n-1}{j}^2 \\
&= n \sum_{j=0}^{n-1} \binom{n-1}{j} \binom{n-1}{n-1-j} \\
&= n \binom{2n-2}{n-1}.
\end{aligned}$$

Therefore,

$$\begin{aligned}
\frac{S_{2022}}{S_{2021}} &= \frac{2022 \binom{4042}{2021}}{2021 \binom{4040}{2020}} \\
&= \frac{4044 \cdot 4041}{2021^2}.
\end{aligned}$$

This is in the lowest term. Therefore, modulo 1000,

$$\begin{aligned}
p + q &\equiv 4044 \cdot 4041 + 2021^2 \\
&\equiv 44 \cdot 41 + 21^2 \\
&\equiv \boxed{245}.
\end{aligned}$$

~Steven Chen (www.professorchen.edu.com)

Solution 4

Let's ask what the contribution of an element $k \in \{1, 2, \dots, n\}$ is to the sum $S_n = \sum |A \cap B|$.

The answer is given by the number of (A, B) such that $|A| = |B|$ and $k \in A \cap B$, which is given by $\binom{2n-2}{n-1}$ by the following construction: Write down 1 to n except k in a row. Do the same in a second row. Then choose $n-1$ numbers out of these $2n-2$ numbers. k and the numbers chosen in the first row make up A . k and the numbers not chosen in the second row make up B . This is a one-to-one correspondence between (A, B) and the ways to choose $n-1$ numbers from $2n-2$ numbers.

The contribution from all elements is therefore

$$S_n = n \binom{2n-2}{n-1}.$$

For the rest please see Solution 1 or 2.

~qyang

NOTE: you may have a concern, "what if we chose the same element twice in a set?" Let us look at an example. Suppose we are partitioning S_4 , $k = 4$, and we list out the rows top: 1, 2, 3 bottom: 1, 2, 3. If we chose 1 (top) 2 (top) and 1 (bottom), then we can distribute these numbers by sending the numbers in the top row that were chosen to set A , which would be 1, 2, 4, and set B would be the numbers not chosen in the bottom row, which would be 2, 3, 4. To prove this rigorously, let x be the number of elements in the top row chosen and y be the number of elements chosen in the bottom row. Since we choose $n-1$ objects, $x + y = n-1$. So the amount of elements in A would be $1 + x$, and the amount of elements in B would be

$$1 + (n - 1 - y) = 1 + n - 1 - (n - 1 - x) = x + 1.$$

~eqb5000

Solution 5 (No strange notation, proof of all combo lemmas provided)

Assume the subset A of $\{1, 2, 3, \dots, n\}$ has k elements, where k is some integer from 0 to n , inclusive. Then, there are $\binom{n}{k}$ ways to choose A . Now, we find the amount of ways to choose B , given A . Assume that A and B have a elements in common, where $0 \leq a \leq k$. Then, a of the elements in B are also in A , so we can pick $\binom{k}{a}$ elements here, and the remaining $k - a$ elements in B are not in A , so we can pick $\binom{n-k}{k-a}$ elements here. Therefore, there are $\binom{k}{a} \binom{n-k}{k-a}$ ways to select B if A and B have a elements in common.

However, if A and B have a elements in common, the ordered pair (A, B) will contribute a to the total sum. Thus, we multiply by a . Since the amount of ways to choose B ranges over all $0 \leq a \leq k$, we seek the sum;

$$\binom{n}{k} \sum_{a=0}^k a \binom{k}{a} \binom{n-k}{k-a}.$$

The $\binom{n}{k}$ on the outside of the sum represents the amount of ways to choose A . Now, we simplify the $a \binom{k}{a}$ term a little bit

$$\text{Note that } a \binom{k}{a} = a \cdot \frac{k!}{a!(k-a)!} = \frac{k!}{(a-1)!(k-a)!} = k \cdot \frac{(k-1)!}{(a-1)!(k-a)!} = k \binom{k-1}{a-1}$$

The reason we did this is because we want the a in the combination expression, and not as a scale factor. Then, the sum simplifies to

$$\binom{n}{k} \sum_{a=0}^k k \binom{k-1}{a-1} \binom{n-k}{k-a}. \text{ We can take } k \text{ out of the sum (it's a constant in the sum), and the sum turns into}$$

$$k \binom{n}{k} \sum_{a=0}^k \binom{k-1}{a-1} \binom{n-k}{k-a}.$$

Now, we use a combinatorial identity called Vandermode's Identity (This identity is well known, if you don't know it, learn it; it's useful for these types of problems).

Consider $x + y$ people. We wish to form a committee with r people. We can do this in $\binom{x+y}{r}$ ways. However, we can choose k people from the group of x people and $r - k$ people from the other y people, for all $0 \leq k \leq r$.

$$\text{This is done in } \sum_{k=0}^r \binom{x}{k} \binom{y}{r-k} \text{ ways, but this is also equal to } \binom{x+y}{r}.$$

In our desired sum, we have $x = k - 1$, $y = n - k$, and $r = (a - 1) + (k - a) = k - 1$. Thus, the summation part is equal to $\binom{n-1}{k-1}$, and

$$\text{the total product is } k \binom{n}{k} \binom{n-1}{k-1}.$$

Now, we want to sum this over all possible k , for $0 \leq k \leq n$.

$$\text{This is } \sum_{k=0}^n k \binom{n}{k} \binom{n-1}{k-1}. \text{ We can do something with the } k \binom{n}{k} \text{ term that was similar to something we did last time to obtain that this is also equal to } n \binom{n-1}{k-1}.$$

$$\text{Then, the sum simplifies to } n \sum_{k=0}^n \binom{n-1}{k-1} \binom{n-1}{k-1} = n \sum_{k=0}^n \binom{n-1}{k-1}^2.$$

We can use Vandermode's again, with $x = y = n - 1$ and $r = (k - 1) + (k - 1) = 2k - 2$. Then, the sum is equal to $n \binom{2n-2}{n-1}$.

Now, the problem seeks $\frac{S_{2022}}{S_{2021}}$. This is equal to

$$\frac{2022 \binom{4042}{2021}}{2021 \binom{4040}{2020}} = \frac{\frac{2022 \cdot 4042!}{2021! \cdot 2021!}}{\frac{2021 \cdot 4040!}{2020! \cdot 2020!}} = \frac{2022 \cdot 4042! \cdot 2020! \cdot 2020!}{2021 \cdot 4040! \cdot 2021! \cdot 2021!} = \frac{2022 \cdot 4042 \cdot 4041}{2021 \cdot 2021 \cdot 2021} = \frac{2022 \cdot 2 \cdot 4041}{2021 \cdot 2021}.$$

We seek $2022 \cdot 2 \cdot 4041 + 2021 \cdot 2021 \pmod{1000}$. This is equivalent to $22 \cdot 82 + 21 \cdot 21 \equiv 804 + 441 \equiv \boxed{245} \pmod{1000}$, and we are done.

Video Solution

<https://youtu.be/cXJmHV5BnfY> ~MathProblemSolvingSkills.com

<https://youtu.be/wTYXkE32v9o> ~AMC & AIME Training

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